Fiscal Year:	FY 2006	**Task Last Updated:**	FY 05/20/2006
PI Name:	Jacobs, Jeffrey Ph.D.		
Project Title:	An Experimental Investigation of Incompressible Richtmyer-Meshkov Instability		
Division Name:	Physical Sciences		
Program/Discipline:	FLUID PHYSICS		
Program/Discipline--Element/Subdiscipline:	FLUID PHYSICS--Dynamics and stability		
Joint Agency Name:		**TechPort:**	No
Human Research Program Elements:	None		
Human Research Program Risks:	None		
Space Biology Element:	None		
Space Biology Cross-Element Discipline:	None		
Space Biology Special Category:	None		
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Zip Code:	85721	**Congressional District:**	7
Comments:			
Project Type:	Ground	**Solicitation / Funding Source:**	00-HEDS-02
Start Date:	01/18/2002	**End Date:**	11/30/2006
No. of Post Docs:	0	**No. of PhD Degrees:**	0
No. of PhD Candidates:	0	**No. of Master' Degrees:**	2
No. of Master's Candidates:	2	**No. of Bachelor's Degrees:**	0
No. of Bachelor's Candidates:	0	**Monitoring Center:**	NASA GRC
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Flight Program:			
Flight Assignment:			
Key Personnel Changes/Previous PI:	0		
COI Name (Institution):	Niederhaus, Charles (NASA Glenn Research Center)		
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Performance Goal No.:			
Performance Goal Text:			

Richtmyer-Meshkov instability occurs when a planar interface separating two fluids of different densities is impulsively accelerated in the direction of its normal. The focus of this research project is to observe and quantify the nonlinear development of this instability from a simple well characterized initial state into a turbulent flow, and to determine whether a self-preserving final turbulent state is achieved. The experiments utilize a novel experimental apparatus which circumvents many of the experimental difficulties that have previously limited the study of Richtmyer-Meshkov instability. In this system, the instability is generated by impulsively accelerating a rectangular box containing two liquids. The effects of gravity are minimized by keeping the fluids in free-fall. Previous NASA funding supported the construction of a laboratory apparatus in which the impulsive acceleration is imparted by bouncing the fluid box off of a fixed spring. The current project will extend the previous study and focus on the turbulent regime to determine self-similarity and to obtain the turbulent growth rate. The extended duration of microgravity offered by the 2.2 Second Drop Tower at GRC and the KC-135 Reduced Gravity Aircraft will be utilized to study the turbulent regime. An

Task Description:	adaptation of the existing laboratory apparatus for use in the 2.2 Second Drop Tower was initiated under previous NASA funding. Experiments will therefore initially be carried out in this facility using the new apparatus and later progress to the Reduced Gravity Aircraft. The adaptation of the experiments to the KC-135 will be aided by experiments at the University of Arizona that will focus on developing techniques for initial interface formation using paramagnetic fluids. These methods will also prove useful for a possible future space experiment. The objective of the funded research is to carry out ground-based experiments to study the nonlinear development and transition to turbulence of Richtmyer-Meshkov instability with the goal of quantifying the development of the resulting turbulent flow and to determine if a self-similar state is achieved. The long term objective of this project is to develop methods and procedures for a possible future flight experiment in order utilize the low gravity environment of space for the creation of an experiment with virtually unlimited duration to study the fully turbulent Richtmyer-Meshkov instability. Richtmyer-Meshkov instability is one of the most fundamental of fluid instabilities and is of importance in fields ranging from astrophysics to materials processing. For example, Richtmyer-Meshkov instability is of critical importance to inertial confinement fusion. The degree of compression capable in laser fusion experiments is ultimately limited by Richtmyer-Meshkov instability and another similar instability called Rayleigh-Taylor instability. Thus, these instabilities represent the single most significant barrier to attaining positive-net-yield fusion reactions in laser fusion facilities. Richtmyer-Meshkov instability is also of importance to high speed combustion applications, where, for example, it can greatly enhance mixing and thus significantly alter the burning rate. Knowledge gained from this study should aid in the design of laser fusion targets and supersonic combustors.
Rationale for HRP Directed Research:	
Research Impact/Earth Benefits:	
Task Progress:	Work the past year has been focused on the development of our capability to produce stable interfaces in microgravity using magnetic fluids. Earlier work in this effort has concentrated on evaluating electromagnet configurations for this purpose, modeling them using the finite element package ANSYS. Using the results of this analysis it was decided to implement a dipole electromagnet configuration and we have recently installed a large (10” pole diameter) electromagnet with power supply. More recent work has been focused on using ANSYS to determine the optimum pole face geometry to carry out the dipole experiments. In this study field distributions were computed to determine the best pole contour for providing a large field gradient while also providing nearly horizontal field contours. The results of this research have indicated that a cosine pole face satisfies our requirements and this shape has subsequently been machined onto the poles of our electromagnet. Preliminary experiments utilizing this configuration have demonstrated its ability to stabilize a heaver magnetic fluid on top of a lighter magnetic one, and have confirmed our calculations predicting that this choice of pole geometry does generate a flat interface. As a result, we have recently completed an experimental investigation of the magnetically stabilized Rayleigh-Taylor instability utilizing this system. During this past year we have begun an experimental investigation which utilizes the properties of paramagnetic liquids to study Rayleigh-Taylor instability. The liquids, a miscible combination of paramagnetic salt solution and one of three nonmagnetic solutions, are contained in a tank placed between the poles of our electromagnet. First the nonmagnetic lighter liquid is placed in the bottom half of the tank. Then, after the magnetic field is turned on, the heavier magnetic liquid is placed on top. The magnetic field is capable of suspending the heavy paramagnetic fluid over the lighter non-magnetic fluid utilizing the gradient field principle. Rayleigh-Taylor instability is then initiated by rapidly removing power to the electromagnet which results in the heavy fluid falling under the influence of gravity. The resulting instability is visualized using backlit photography. Experiments initiated with an initially flat interface develop into a random surface pattern with a dominant length scale well approximated by the fastest growing wavelength given by viscous linear stability theory. Measurements of the mean mixing zone width are observed to follow a gt^2 dependence with a constant of proportionality that falls within the range found in previous experimental studies.
Bibliography Type:	Description: (Last Updated: 02/26/2014)
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Dissertations and Theses	Romero-Colio P. "An experimental study of Rayleigh-Taylor instability using paramagnetic fluids." M.S. Thesis, University of Arizona, August 2005. , Aug-2005